

“It is a fateful moment for us in India, for all Asia and for the world. A new star rises, the star of freedom in the east, a new hope comes into being, a vision long cherished materialises. May the star never set and that hope never be betrayed!”

Jawaharlal Nehru, 1947

The English first arrived on the subcontinent as traders in the 1600s. At the time, India was a vastly wealthy trading giant with international connections and a diversity of people, cultures, languages and religions. Over the next two hundred years, the English turned from traders into colonial masters and established a whole system of government to achieve their primary goal: the transfer of India’s wealth to their own faraway country. Indian lives